



Lego: The Hobbit

Lego: The Hobbit game has been slated for a 2014 release
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millions of its citizens. In an essay written in 'Reimagining India: Unlocking The Potential of Asia's Next Superpower' edited by global consulting firm McKinsey, Schmidt said that India is 'an Internet laggard'. He added that India needed to increase its internet penetration in towns and cities to unleash the country's full potential.

"Just think what will happen when India's entrepreneurial innovators are able to create great global companies without leaving their country. They will change the world. Hundreds of large firms focused on the Internet will be founded and will succeed by focusing purely on Indian consumers, Indian taste, Indian style, Indian sports. Can anyone of those companies ultimately become the next Google? Of course."

Schmidt said, "That may not happen for quite a few years. But if India plays its cards right, we will soon see Indian engineers and small businesses tackling Indian problems first, then exporting the solutions that work best."

Schmidt added that he believes India is on the cusp of a connectivity revolution. "I believe India has the chance to leapfrog its current connectivity challenges, bring internet access to a majority of its citizens, and even raise its penetration ratio to 60 or 70 percent within the next 5-10 years", he said.

India has approximately 600 million mobile phone users, but only 150 million people regularly connect to the internet. However India's Internet penetration rate in 2011 was just 11 percent, which is less than a third of China's penetration ratio of 38 percent and less than half of those in developing countries (24 percent).

Social change campaign to help women get online

Google India has launched the 'Helping Women get Online' campaign. The initiative is aimed at encouraging women in the country to use the online medium more effectively.

Google states that lack of easy access to the internet as well as lack of knowledge on how to use it has been one of the biggest barriers for women to get online. At present, India has over 200 million internet users, but only one-third of



Google to get 50 million women online by the end of 2014

them are women. The initiative will help 50 million additional women get online by the end of 2014 by undertaking various projects across India.

Google has launched a mass media campaign and a specially designed website www.hwgo.com as a first step in the initiative. The site will have content covering the very basics of the Internet and special content that is relevant for women in India, available both in Hindi and English languages. Women can also access a toll-free helpline number 1800-41-999-77 to get answers for any queries that they may have about the internet. The initiative is being supported by Intel, HUL and Axis Bank. Intel will also

launch a mobile app called "Easy Step" for women on the Google Play Store.

Yonca Brunini, the VP for Marketing Google said that this initiative will benefit numerous women. He stated, "With this project, we successfully completed a digital literacy effort of training over 100,000 women in Bhilwara and trained them on how to use the basic applications on the Internet. The learnings from the pilot will help us to work on a framework which we will use to roll out in other parts of India."

Google and Microsoft change search algorithm to fight child porn

Search engine giants Google and Microsoft are modifying search algorithms to block content that encourages child sex abuse. They have modified more than 100,000 search terms that show results in videos and images of child sex abuse on the Internet. The search engines began to work on this after UK Prime Minister David Cameron in June demanded Google and other Internet giants to get rid of child abuse images online.

Google boss Eric Schmidt stated that the tech giant has developed new technology

that makes it harder to find child sexual abuse images on the web. The restrictions will initially apply to English-speaking countries but will be expanded to the rest of the world and 158 other languages within six months.

Google Chairman Eric Schmidt wrote in an article for the Daily Mail recently, "We've listened, and in the last three months put more than 200 people to work developing new, state-of-the-art technology to tackle the problem. We've fine-tuned Google search to prevent links to child sexual abuse material from appearing in our results."

"While no algorithm is perfect – and Google cannot prevent paedophiles adding new images to the web – these changes have cleaned up the results for over 100,000 queries that might be related to the sexual abuse of kids."

He added that once it's determined that content represents genuine abuse it is assigned a unique digital fingerprint that speeds up the detection and deletion process when the images appear in Google's system. Schmidt wrote, "Microsoft deserves a lot of credit for developing and sharing its picture detection technology."

He added that engineers at YouTube have also created a new technology to identify child porn videos on the video-sharing site and it would be sharing the technology with other Internet companies and child protection agencies. The announcement by Eric Schmidt was made ahead of the Internet Safety Summit at Prime Minister David Cameron's Downing Street office, which Google, Microsoft and other Internet firms will be attending soon. 